🏛 Polity & Governance — Master File · SSC CGL

> **The single consolidated Polity & Governance resource** — Constitution, Fundamental Rights/Duties, DPSP, Parliament, Executive, Judiciary, Amendments, plus Governance (schemes, e-governance, appointments). 🔴 **Highest-yield, easiest-marks GA section** per the PYQ Blueprint.

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1. How SSC Asks Polity (PYQ Question-Types)

PYQs are the blueprint. SSC recycles these exact question *shapes* — recognise the type and you know what to memorise:

Question type	Example stem	What to prep
Borrowed-from	"DPSP was borrowed from —"	Source-country table (§2)
Article-number match	"Art. 280 deals with —"	High-yield Articles (§4)
Which Amendment	"Right to Education was added by —"	Amendments 42/44/73/74/86 (§6)
Schedule match	"Anti-defection is in which Schedule?"	12 Schedules (§4)
Which House / who	"Money Bill originates in —"	Parliament facts (§5)
Count	"How many Fundamental Duties?"	6 FRs, 11 FDs, 5 writs

> These 6 types cover the bulk of the section. Everything below is organised to answer them fast.

2. The Constitution — Making & Sources

- **Constituent Assembly** formed under the **Cabinet Mission Plan (1946)**; first sitting **9 Dec 1946**.
- **Permanent President:** Dr. Rajendra Prasad · **Temporary:** Dr. Sachchidananda Sinha.
- **Drafting Committee Chairman: Dr. B. R. Ambedkar** ("Father of the Indian Constitution").
- **Adopted:** 26 Nov 1949 (Constitution Day) · **In force: 26 Jan 1950** (Republic Day).
- Took **2 yrs 11 months 18 days**. Originally **395 Articles, 22 Parts, 8 Schedules**.

- Preamble inspired by the **Objectives Resolution** (Nehru). "Socialist, Secular, Integrity" added by the **42nd Amendment (1976)**.

"Bag of borrowings" (very high-yield):

Feature	Borrowed from
Fundamental Rights, Judicial Review, Preamble (idea)	**USA**
Parliamentary system, Rule of Law, Single citizenship	**UK**
DPSP	**Ireland**
Emergency provisions	**Germany**
Concurrent List, trade & commerce	**Australia**
Fundamental Duties, Five-Year Plans	**USSR**
Liberty–Equality–Fraternity	**France**
Federation with strong Centre	**Canada**

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3. Fundamental Rights, DPSP & Duties

Fundamental Rights (Part III) — 6 rights:

1. **Equality (14–18)** · 2. **Freedom (19–22)** · 3. **Against Exploitation (23–24)** · 4. **Freedom of Religion (25–28)** · 5. **Cultural & Educational (29–30)** · 6. **Constitutional Remedies (32)**.

- **Right to Property** removed as an FR by the **44th Amendment (1978)** → now a legal right (Art. 300A).
- **5 Writs:** Habeas Corpus, Mandamus, Prohibition, Certiorari, Quo Warranto.

Right to Equality (memory trick, Art. 14–18):

14 → Equality before law · 15 → No discrimination · 16 → Equal opportunity (public jobs) · 17 → Abolition of untouchability · 18 → Abolition of titles.

DPSP (Part IV): non-justiciable ideals — Gandhian, Socialist, Liberal-Intellectual. Art. 40 (Panchayati Raj), 44 (UCC), 48 (cow protection), 51 (international peace).

Fundamental Duties (Part IVA, Art. 51A): added by the **42nd Amendment (1976)** on the **Swaran Singh Committee** recommendation; **10 → now 11** (11th, education, added by 86th Amendment).

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4. Important Articles & Schedules

High-yield Articles:

Art.	Subject
1	Union of States
14 / 19 / 21	Equality / Six freedoms / Life & liberty
21A	Right to Education (added by 86th Amdt, 2002)
32	Constitutional Remedies ("heart & soul" — Ambedkar)
72 / 123	President's pardon / Ordinance power
143	SC advisory opinion
148 / 280	CAG / Finance Commission
324 / 343	Election Commission / Official language (Hindi)
352 / 356 / 360	National / State / Financial Emergency
368 / 370	Amendment procedure / J&K special status (abrogated 2019)

Schedules (12 total): 1st States/UTs · 2nd salaries · 3rd oaths · 4th Rajya Sabha seats · 5th Scheduled Areas · 6th Tribal areas (Assam, Meghalaya, Tripura, Mizoram) · **7th three Lists (Union/State/Concurrent)** · **8th 22 languages** · 9th laws immune from review · **10th anti-defection** · 11th Panchayats (29 subjects) · 12th Municipalities (18 subjects).

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5. Parliament, President, PM & Judiciary

Parliament = Lok Sabha + Rajya Sabha + President.

- **Lok Sabha:** max 552; term 5 yrs; presiding officer **Speaker**; **Money Bills (Art. 110) originate only here**.
- **Rajya Sabha:** max 250 (238 elected + 12 nominated); **permanent house**, 1/3 retire every 2 yrs; Chairman = **Vice-President**.

President (Art. 52–62): Head of State; elected **indirectly by an electoral college** (elected MPs + elected MLAs), single transferable vote. Qualification: citizen, **35+**, LS-eligible. Impeachment (Art. 61) for "violation of the Constitution."

Vice-President (Art. 63–71): ex-officio Chairman of Rajya Sabha.

PM & Council of Ministers (Art. 74–75): PM = real executive head, appointed by President; Council **collectively responsible to the Lok Sabha**.

Judiciary: Supreme Court (Art. 124) = CJI + 33 judges (sanctioned **34**). SC judges retire at **65**, HC at **62**. Powers: original, appellate, advisory jurisdiction; **judicial review**.

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6. Key Amendments (🔴 must-know)

Amdt	Change
1st (1951)	Added Ninth Schedule
7th (1956)	Linguistic reorganisation of states
42nd (1976)	"Mini Constitution" — Socialist, Secular, Integrity, Fundamental Duties
44th (1978)	Right to Property removed from FRs
52nd (1985)	Anti-defection law (Tenth Schedule)
61st (1989)	Voting age 21 → 18
73rd & 74th (1992)	Panchayati Raj & Urban local bodies
86th (2002)	Right to Education (Art. 21A)
101st (2016)	GST
103rd (2019)	10% EWS reservation

7. Governance — Schemes, e-Governance, Appointments

Flagship schemes (name → purpose/ministry):

Scheme	Purpose
PM Jan Dhan Yojana	Financial inclusion (bank accounts)
PM Ujjwala Yojana	LPG connections to BPL women
PM Awas Yojana	Housing for all
PM Kisan Samman Nidhi	₹6,000/yr income support to farmers
Ayushman Bharat (PM-JAY)	Health insurance ₹5 lakh/family
MGNREGA	100 days guaranteed rural wage employment
Beti Bachao Beti Padhao	Child sex ratio & girl education
Swachh Bharat Mission	Sanitation
Digital India	Digital infrastructure ("Power to Empower")
Make in India	Manufacturing
Skill India / PMKVY	Skilling
Atmanirbhar Bharat	Self-reliance

e-Governance portals: UMANG (unified services app), DigiLocker (documents), e-Hospital, GeM (Govt e-Marketplace), MyGov (citizen engagement), CoWIN, PRAGATI (PM's review platform).

Constitutional/statutory appointments (who appoints whom):

- **President appoints:** PM, Governors, CJI & SC/HC judges, CAG, Attorney General, Election Commissioners, UPSC/Finance Commission chairs.
- **CAG** (Art. 148) — audits govt accounts, reports to Parliament.
- **Election Commission** (Art. 324) — CEC + 2 ECs.

- **Attorney General** (Art. 76) — highest law officer of the Union.

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8. Curated PYQ-Pattern Questions

Q1. Constitution came into force on — (a) 26 Nov 1949 (b) 15 Aug 1947 (c) **26 Jan 1950** (d) 26 Jan 1930

Q2. Chairman of the Drafting Committee — (a) Rajendra Prasad (b) Nehru (c) **B. R. Ambedkar** (d) Patel

Q3. "Socialist" & "Secular" added by — (a) 24th (b) **42nd** (c) 44th (d) 52nd

Q4. "Heart and soul" of the Constitution — (a) Art.14 (b) Art.19 (c) Art.21 (d) **Art.32**

Q5. Right to Education (Art. 21A) added by — (a) 42nd (b) 44th (c) **86th** (d) 73rd

Q6. Money Bills introduced only in — (a) Rajya Sabha (b) **Lok Sabha** (c) Either (d) Joint session

Q7. DPSP borrowed from — (a) USA (b) UK (c) **Ireland** (d) Canada

Q8. FR removed by 44th Amendment — (a) Equality (b) **Property** (c) Freedom (d) Religion

Q9. Fundamental Duties added by — (a) **42nd** (b) 44th (c) 52nd (d) 1st

Q10. Ex-officio Chairman of Rajya Sabha — (a) Speaker (b) President (c) **Vice-President** (d) PM

Q11. President elected by — (a) public (b) LS only (c) **electoral college** (d) Council of Ministers

Q12. Anti-defection law is in which Schedule — (a) 8th (b) 9th (c) **10th** (d) 12th

Q13. Languages in the Eighth Schedule — (a) 14 (b) 18 (c) **22** (d) 28

Q14. 73rd & 74th Amendments deal with — (a) GST (b) **Local self-government** (c) Anti-defection (d) Reservation

Q15. Writ to release from illegal detention — (a) Mandamus (b) Quo Warranto (c) **Habeas Corpus** (d) Certiorari

Q16. Preamble idea borrowed from — (a) **USA** (b) Ireland (c) Australia (d) Canada

Q17. Concurrent List borrowed from — (a) UK (b) USA (c) **Australia** (d) Canada

Q18. Number of Fundamental Duties at present — (a) 9 (b) 10 (c) **11** (d) 12

Q19. Article 280 deals with — (a) Election Commission (b) **Finance Commission** (c) CAG (d) UPSC

Q20. Minimum age to become President — (a) 25 (b) 30 (c) **35** (d) 40

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9. Freshly-Created Practice Questions

New questions in the SSC pattern; answer key at the end.

N1. The Constituent Assembly was formed under the —

(a) Government of India Act 1935 (b) Cabinet Mission Plan 1946 (c) Cripps Mission (d) Mountbatten Plan

N2. Emergency provisions in the Indian Constitution were borrowed from —

(a) USA (b) Germany (c) Ireland (d) Canada

N3. The Fundamental Duties were added on the recommendation of the —

(a) Sarkaria Commission (b) Swaran Singh Committee (c) Balwant Rai Mehta Committee (d) Ashok Mehta Committee

N4. The maximum strength of the Rajya Sabha is —

(a) 245 (b) 250 (c) 552 (d) 238

N5. The Sixth Schedule deals with the administration of tribal areas in —

(a) Rajasthan, Gujarat (b) Assam, Meghalaya, Tripura, Mizoram (c) Punjab, Haryana (d) Kerala, Karnataka

N6. The Comptroller and Auditor General (CAG) is provided under which Article?

(a) Art. 148 (b) Art. 280 (c) Art. 324 (d) Art. 76

N7. "Power to Empower" is the slogan of which programme?

(a) Make in India (b) Digital India (c) Skill India (d) Startup India

N8. Ayushman Bharat (PM-JAY) provides health cover of —

(a) ₹1 lakh (b) ₹2 lakh (c) ₹5 lakh (d) ₹10 lakh per family per year

N9. The GST was introduced by which Constitutional Amendment?

(a) 100th (b) 101st (c) 103rd (d) 86th

N10. DigiLocker and UMANG are examples of —

(a) tax portals (b) e-governance platforms (c) banking apps (d) social media

Answer Key (Section 9):

N1-(b) Cabinet Mission Plan · N2-(b) Germany · N3-(b) Swaran Singh Committee · N4-(b) 250 · N5-(b) Assam/Meghalaya/Tripura/Mizoram · N6-(a) Art. 148 · N7-(b) Digital India · N8-(c) ₹5 lakh · N9-(b) 101st · N10-(b) e-governance platforms

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10. Rapid Revision Sheet

- Adopted 26 Nov 1949; in force 26 Jan 1950 · Drafting chair → Ambedkar · CA president → Rajendra Prasad
- Preamble idea/FR/Judicial review → USA · DPSP → Ireland · Emergency → Germany · FDs/Plans → USSR
- "Socialist, Secular, Integrity" → 42nd Amdt · 6 FRs; Property removed → 44th; FDs now 11 (42nd + 86th)
- Art. 14 equality · 19 six freedoms · 21 life & liberty · 21A education · **32 heart & soul** · 280 Finance Commission · 324 EC · 368 amendment · 370 J&K (abrogated 2019)
- 5 writs: Habeas Corpus, Mandamus, Prohibition, Certiorari, Quo Warranto
- Money Bill → only Lok Sabha · Rajya Sabha chair → VP · President elected by electoral college, min age 35
- SC = CJI + 33 (34); retire SC 65 / HC 62 · Schedules: 8th → 22 languages, 10th → anti-defection
- Amendments: 42 (mini-constitution) · 44 (property) · 52 (anti-defection) · 61 (age 18) · 73/74 (local bodies) · 86 (education) · 101 (GST) · 103 (EWS)
- Schemes: Jan Dhan (accounts) · Ujjwala (LPG) · PM-Kisan (₹6000) · Ayushman (₹5 lakh) · MGNREGA (100 days)
- President appoints PM/Governors/judges/CAG/AG/CEC · CAG → Art.148 · EC → Art.324 · AG → Art.76

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